

open for public use, and a Hybrid cloud is a composition of two or more clouds that remain unique entities but are bound to each other. And just as we start to thank Lord Almighty because these terms seem to be slightly definitive, we come across the Personal cloud. Now while the Personal cloud could be generalised as an application of cloud computing specifically for individuals, it still has pretty diverse implications. A personal cloud could mean clouds that exist at home or in a business, and are managed by an individual, in the form of storage devices that are controlled by the individual themselves.

The term is also alternatively used to define any server space that you have control over as an individual and get to choose file access and restrictions, even if it means that the hardware is 3rd party owned; this would cover applications like Dropbox, Google Drive etc. which we've already covered in our previous topic "Cloud Storage and Syncing". So when we talk of the Personal cloud, in the context of this chapter we prefer the former definition



– that of a storage appliance that by itself or through another device, can be accessed wirelessly over the internet, thus providing data transfer across various devices over the “cloud”.

So how exactly can we setup our very own Personal cloud? It's pretty easy actually. There are different ways to go about it. For one, there are software and open source services out there that offer similar functionality as services like Dropbox or Google Drive do. But instead of storing the data on third party servers, these software let you install them on any computer you control, thus enabling you to host your own cloud server. These open source software such as OwnCloud run on pretty much every environment that allows you to install it on platforms like Ubuntu server giving you the flexibility that you want. This means you could just get an old computer with all the data you need stored on it (or get an external HDD, and connect it to the comp), install the software and use it as your very own personal cloud server. The best part about services such as OwnCloud or Tonido, is that you can